

The planning consultants Initial statement said that I needed a Number of drawings

1. Location plan
2. Existing site plan
3. Proposed site plan
4. Existing building elevations and floor plan (Of building to be demolished)
5. Proposed building elevations and floor plan

Analyze my notes and explain step-by-step how I can achieve everything below as efficiently as possible, relying on AI tools, free software, and DIY methods instead of consultants or mapping vendors.

Context & Goals (My Brain Dump):

- **Location & Site Plans:** I need a 1:2500 Location Plan with a Red Line Boundary (application site) and a Blue Line Boundary (adjacent land I own). I also need a matching Site Plan showing individual buildings (*i.e. Billeaford Hall, Former dairy, timber garage, East Barn, West Barn, other former agricultural barns and stores,*),
- **Proposed site plan**
This would show the proposed new building, and a revised driveway connecting to the existing layout. (I'm assuming they need to see what's going to be hard surfaces like the driveway.)
- I assume the building labels will be required on this plan too?
Please check...Is the red and blue line boundaries are requirement for the site plan as opposed to the location plan?
- **Cost & Mapping Vendors:** I want to avoid paying OS mapping partners per map if legally possible. I already have a rather colorful Promap of the site, but concerned its bright yellows/greens may look inconsistent when paired with standard monochrome OS maps.

Other questions to Answer:

1. Mapping Rules & Cost-Free Options:

- Do East Suffolk Council or Suffolk County Council legally require official Ordnance Survey (OS) licensed maps (like 'Promap' or 'BuyaPlan', or will free/alternative basemaps (e.g., OpenStreetMap, INSPIRE data, planning portals) be accepted?
- How can I get valid 1:2500 and site-scale maps for free or low cost without visual mismatches?

2. DIY Drawing & Annotation Setup:

- How do I add the mandatory **North Arrow**, **Scale Bar**, **Scale Text**, and precise **Red/Blue Line Boundaries** without online map tools? What free software (e.g., QGIS, Canva, Inkscape) is best for this?

- What paper size (A4 vs. A3) should I set to ensure the map covers my full plot at 1:2500 without breaking scale accuracy when printed? What file format (PDF, PNG) do councils require?

3. Drawing Proposed Changes (Driveway & New Building):

- What is the easiest way to mock up the new driveway lines and proposed building position?
- Can I just describe the dimensions/layout to an AI tool to generate/draw it accurately, or must I draw a rough sketch first and have AI clean it up?

4. Recommended Action Plan:

Outline what you can produce giving me a simple, step-by-step DIY workflow to go from zero to a complete, council-ready planning map set.